the content area. The total size of the element is the sum of the content, padding, and border, while margins add space outside the element's box.

The `box-sizing` property controls how the total width and height of an element are calculated:

- With `box-sizing: content-box` (the default)—Width and height apply to the content only, so padding and borders are added to the outside.

```
total width = content width +
  left padding + right padding + left border + right border
total height = content height +
  top padding + bottom padding + top border + bottom border
```

- With `box-sizing: border-box`—Width and height include the content, padding, and border, making it easier to size elements precisely.

```
actual width of an element = width
actual height of an element = height
```

Using `box-sizing: border-box` is a common best practice for building predictable and maintainable layouts, as demonstrated in listing 2.5.

Listing 2.5 CSS definition for a element

```
div {
  width: 100px;
  height: 50px;
  padding: 5px 10px 20px 30px;
  border: 2px 3px 4px 5px;
  margin: 0;
}
```

When using the default `box-sizing: content-box`, the total width and height of an element are calculated by adding the content dimensions to the padding and border values. For width, start with the content width of 100px, then add the left padding (30px), right padding (10px), left border (5px), and right border (3px). This results in a total width of 100px + 30px + 10px + 5px + 3px = 148px.

For height, begin with the content height of 50px, then add the top padding